

University of Oregon AI Policy Report

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A Report by

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Generative artificial intelligence (AI) became commonplace in education following its widespread availability in the early 2020s.

While adaptation to AI is an ongoing challenge, university policy has yet to address the important ethical issues surrounding AI use and academic integrity.

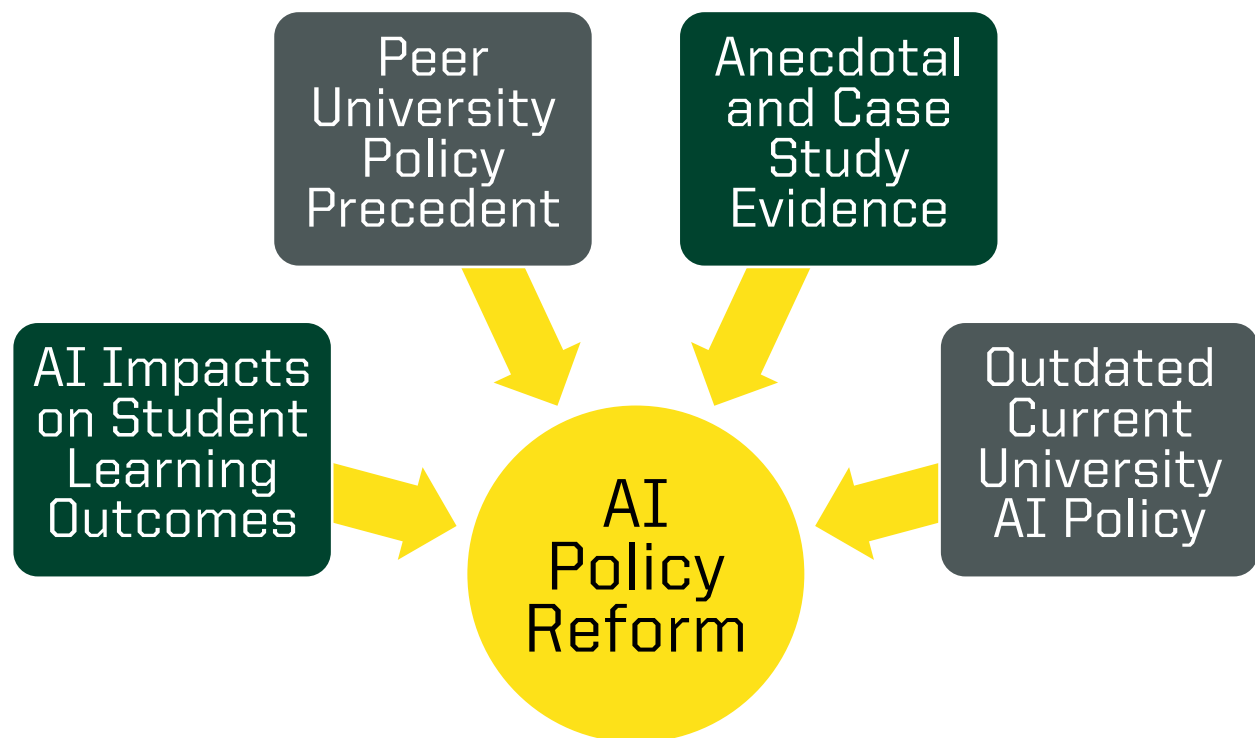
The focus of this report is to explore how academic AI policies can be refined to promote ethical, consistent, and enforceable guidelines for both students and instructors.

Purpose

This report synthesizes current University of Oregon AI policy with peer university policies, and proposes AI policy improvements. This report is based on research surrounding the impact AI has on student learning outcomes.

Methodology

This report concerns the current University of Oregon student conduct code policy. This policy considers unauthorized use of AI as plagiarism, and allows instructors to determine their own guidelines on AI use in their courses ([UO](#)). In order to address the issues with this policy, this report relies on four main sources of information: research on how AI impacts student learning outcomes, Peer University AI policies, Anecdotal and case study evidence of AI abuse and misuse, and a critical analysis of current university policy.

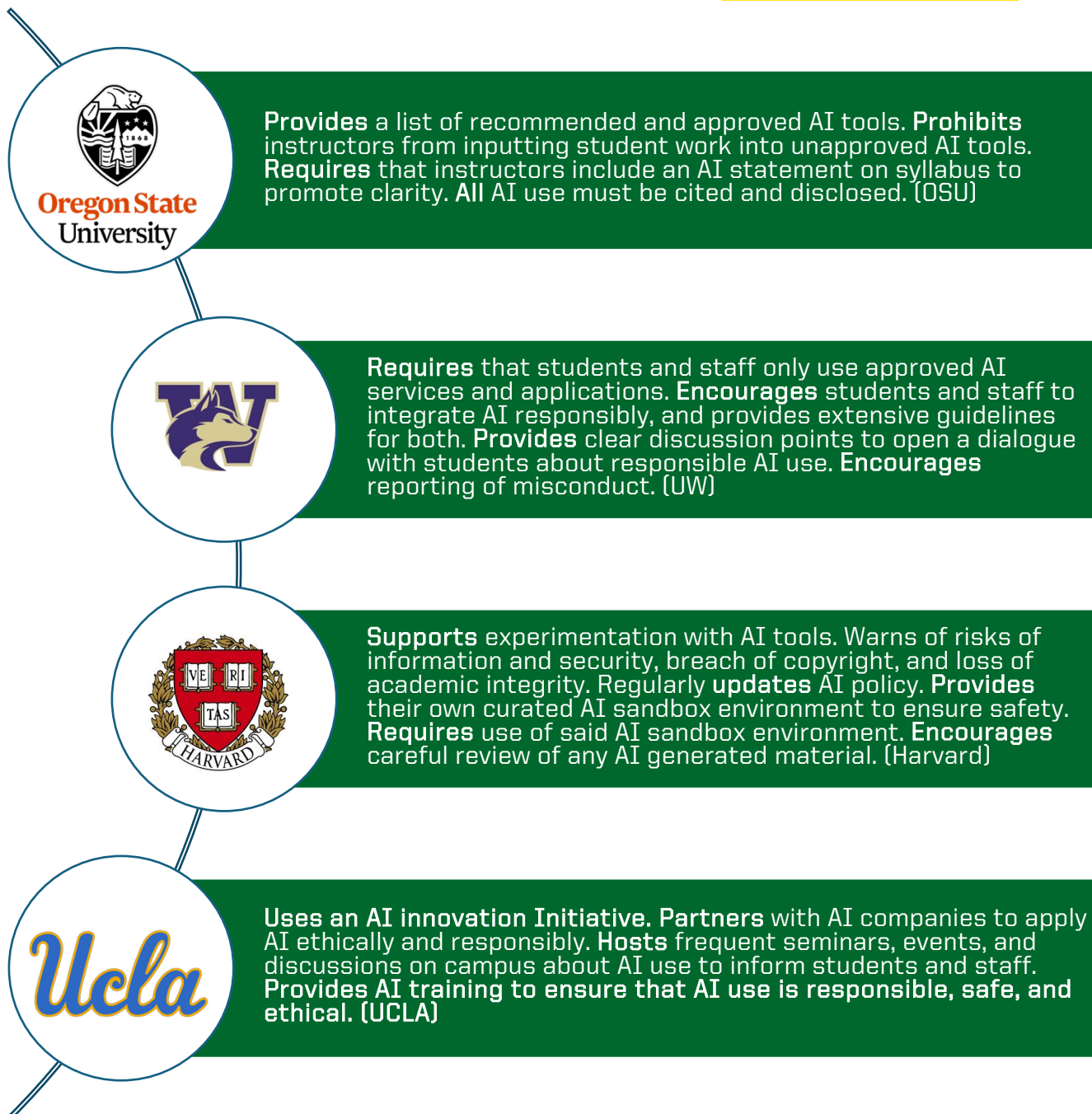


University AI Policy



Peer University Policy Precedent

Policy Survey and Principles



Key Principles of Peer AI Policy

Emphasis on Discourse

The most common element of university AI policy is deterrence through education. Required AI trainings and frequent on-campus seminars cultivate a norm of responsible and ethical AI use.

Required Disclosure

The one element of AI use universities can control is faculty use. Many successful AI policies require instructors to include a university-written AI policy.

Required Software

Many universities have provided both students and staff with a list of safe, secure, and school-approved AI platforms to use.



The benefits of a policy that includes these facets respectively are:

Promotion of responsible use through fundamental AI discourse

Increased ethicality and online safety

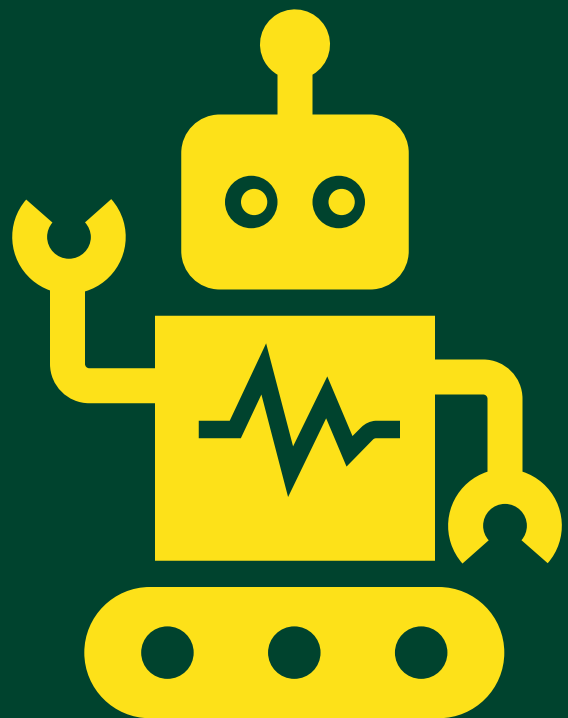
More consistency and clarity for both students and staff

While enforceability remains an issue for every university, helping students understand the loss of their academic integrity through AI use is vital ([Aaron](#)).





Student and Expert Opinions



Student Opinion: My Experience

Anecdotes and Reflection

Notetaking

It is possible for students to effectively record and summarize their lectures with no human input. I have seen students using an AI notetaker while performing unrelated tasks, or leaving the room entirely.

Essay Writing

One of the most problematic uses of AI I have seen is the automation of writing tasks. From full essays to group presentations, many of my peers openly admit to running course prompts through AI engines to produce full essays. Students will simply reword the essay into their own voice before submission.

Article Reading

AI article summarization is the most appealing, and therefore most widespread application of AI I have seen. AI can turn hours of reading into a few minutes of straightforward synopsis and analysis. AI summarization has been integrated directly into search engines and archives. While summarization saves time, the amount of information lost, neglected, or misinterpreted poses a threat to learning outcomes.



Recommendations and Conclusions



Policy Changes

Best Practices

We can draw on peer university policy, as well as educator and student opinions to identify key features of successful policy.

Certainty

The University of Oregon should require all educators to include a specific, centralized AI use guideline in their syllabus. Mandatory usage of school-approved AI tools will increase safety.

Clarity

The University of Oregon should implement and make mandatory a set of guiding principles for AI use, including AI literacy and ethics. If students and staff are trained on AI literacy they will understand the consequences of AI use.

Futureproofing

The University of Oregon should take a less permissive stance on AI use. Since prohibiting AI outright is an untenable solution, AI literacy programs must be implemented as soon as possible. UO has the resources to implement trainings, but has yet to do so.

Enforceability

The University of Oregon should clearly outline rules for responsible AI use, creating opportunity to identify and punish AI misuse. If students use to learn AI as a resource instead of a solution, they are less likely to abuse it.

Conclusions

The evidence is clear that the SCCS's current AI policy does not adequately support students' learning outcomes. Students are robbing themselves of their education and coming out the other side overconfident in their abilities. If UO continues passively allowing all AI guidelines to be written course-by-course, students will complete their education with varying, and at times dangerous understandings of AI literacy and use.

Despite my personal belief that AI tools are disrupting vulnerable communities and causing irreparable harm to our planet and society, I understand that other people will always choose to use them. UO policy should leave students with the tools to use AI responsibly.

AI is a tool that far exceeds the capabilities of humans in one category alone: output. When entire courses can be run through a chrome tab and passed, the value of our education is threatened. Once we come to terms with the reality that is AI and choose to educate our students and staff to use AI responsibly will we be protecting learning outcomes.

Meaningful change begins with UO administration. We need widespread changes: AI literacy courses, reevaluated guidelines, consistent enforcement, and open dialogue. To preserve the value of our education, the SCCS should consider implementation of this proposed policy update.